Ask the fishmonger for the bones when getting fish filleted, and check to see if they have any extra they can give you. Fish bones will freeze, well-wrapped, for up to two months.

fish stock

MAKES 1.5 QT (1.5 L) **PREP** 5 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** 2 MONTHS

1½–2¼lb (675g–1kg) salmon or white fish bones, heads, and skin (don't use those from dark, oily fish such as mackerel, herring, and sardines—they will give an unpleasant flavor)
6 black peppercorns
1 sprig of thyme
1 bay leaf
2 parsley stems
2 small carrots, coarsely chopped
1 onion, coarsely chopped
2 celery ribs, coarsely chopped
1 cup dry white wine
1.7 quarts (1.7 liters) cold water





1 Put the fish heads and bones into a large pan, breaking or cutting them up with a knife to fit. Add the black peppercorns, thyme, bay leaf, and parsley.

2 Add the vegetables to the pot with the wine. Place the pan over medium-high heat and let the wine bubble for 3 minutes. Add the water and bring to a boil.